

they paid too much for Oculus. But if you ask David Coz, one of the creators of the project, it was simply his way of being a VR fan and finding the simplest and cheapest way of experiencing VR. Both Damien Henry, his co-creator, and David Coz were engineers at Google's Cultural Institute at Paris, where they came up with this idea in Google's famous 20% Innovation Time Off. Once Google scientist Christian Plagemann saw the idea, Google decided to go ahead with it as a much larger project.

Launched at the 2014 Google I/O, Cardboard was initially confused as a counter to Facebook's Oculus. But eventually it has been seen as the cheap and accessible tool that can be used to convert non-believers to VR. The



Assembled Google Cardboard. The simplicity of the construction is evident with one look.

common perception of VR has been that of a fringe technology, which further pushes the current technology addicted society deeper into the chasm of social alienation. It saw the future of VR as people strapping computers onto their heads and losing face-to-face contact completely from their lives.

Oculus, the VR torchbearer that initially started as an attempt to democratize VR through the DIY movement, had eventually become a hard-to-reach piece of technology. Therein lies the disparity between people's perception of VR as explained in the last paragraph versus the revolutionary nature of the technology. Most people do not attend electronic trade shows or game developer conferences where products like Oculus and Vive are